

Hollis Dunmore

Character Dossier

Charming and evasive tax collector of Neon Meridian, a rain-soaked megacity

Overview

Hollis Dunmore is a tax collector living in Neon Meridian, a rain-soaked megacity. Hollis is 33 years old, originally from Oldbridge, and is known around the Undermarket as charming and evasive. In conversation Hollis answers a question with a question before giving a real answer.

Background

Hollis arrived in Neon Meridian, a rain-soaked megacity 21 years ago after leaving Oldbridge under circumstances Hollis describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Halcyon Syndicate; the second was the one that stuck. Today Hollis works as a tax collector near Sector 9 transit hub and is paid, when paid at all, in meridian scrip.

Hollis learned the trade from Astrid Nightingale, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Hollis's life is with Ysolde Duskmere, over a matter neither will explain. The person Hollis trusts most is Baptiste Larkspur.

Current goal: to build a boat with no nails in it. Greatest fear: running out of salt.

Personality and speech

Temperament: charming and evasive.

Speech pattern: Hollis answers a question with a question before giving a real answer.

Tells: when lying, Hollis mentions Sorrow the pigeon for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

<i>Full name</i>	Hollis Dunmore
<i>Role</i>	tax collector
<i>Home</i>	Neon Meridian, a rain-soaked megacity
<i>Hometown</i>	Oldbridge
<i>Age</i>	33
<i>Favourite dish</i>	twice-cooked saffron rice
<i>Pet</i>	Sorrow, a pigeon
<i>Lucky number</i>	345

<i>Workshop password</i>	gale-quill
<i>Mentor</i>	Astrid Nightingale
<i>Rival</i>	Ysolde Duskmere
<i>Closest friend</i>	Baptiste Larkspur

Secret

Hollis has a sibling nobody in Neon Meridian, a rain-soaked megacity knows about, living quietly in Oldbridge.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Hollis: I am the tax collector. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Hollis: Twice-cooked saffron rice. Do not tell Ysolde I said so.

Visitor: Is Sorrow yours?

Hollis: Sorrow belongs to nobody. Sorrow tolerates me. Lucky number is 345, if you were about to ask.

Chronicle

Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.

Entry 1, summer of year 38

the Halcyon Syndicate sent a notice about the census. Hollis read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Someone left a ledger on the doorstep with no note. Hollis has a suspect and is probably right. Hollis repaired the wax seal at Sector 9 transit hub for Cassius, who paid in 50 meridian scrip and a long story about the census. Someone left a ledger on the doorstep with no note. Hollis has a suspect and is probably right.

Entry 2, autumn of year 38

Hollis won 27 meridian scrip on a bet about the census and spent all of it on supper. Rumours about the quarantine reached the Glass District. Hollis pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. A stranger asked Hollis for the password to the workshop. Hollis laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Rumours about the new curfew reached the Glass District. Hollis pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 3, summer of year 38

Hollis won 53 meridian scrip on a bet about the new curfew and spent all of it on supper. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the right way to mend a net for an hour and parted better friends than before. Hollis was hired to carry a sextant from the flooded lower rings to Kowloon Arcade without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Hollis was hired to carry a glass float from the flooded lower rings to Kowloon Arcade without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 4, summer of year 38

At the flooded lower rings, Hollis taught a newcomer how to tell a real glass float from a fake one by weight alone. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the tax on doors for an hour and parted better friends than before. Hollis was hired to carry a brass lantern from the flooded lower rings to Kowloon Arcade without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Hollis closed early, walked to Kowloon Arcade, and watched the lights come on. the Halcyon Syndicate sent a notice about the tariff on salt. Hollis read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 5, autumn of year 38

Hollis found a tin whistle half-buried near the flooded lower rings and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Hollis was hired to carry a pair of spectacles from the flooded lower rings to Kowloon Arcade without opening it, and mostly succeeded. the Halcyon Syndicate sent a notice about the quarantine. Hollis read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Hollis won 37 meridian scrip on a bet about the tariff on salt and spent all of it on supper.

Entry 6, autumn of year 38

Hollis found a bundle of letters half-buried near the Undermarket and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Hollis closed early, walked to the Glass District, and watched the lights come on. At the Undermarket, Hollis taught a newcomer how to tell a real bundle of letters from a fake one by

weight alone. Viggo came by asking about the new curfew. Hollis said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 7, spring of year 38

Hollis found a clockwork bird half-buried near the Glass District and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Hollis was hired to carry a sextant from the Glass District to Sector 9 transit hub without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Rumours about the tax on doors reached the Glass District. Hollis pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Hollis closed early, walked to Sector 9 transit hub, and watched the lights come on.

Entry 8, spring of year 38

At Sector 9 transit hub, Hollis taught a newcomer how to tell a real glass float from a fake one by weight alone. A stranger asked Hollis for the password to the workshop. Hollis laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Hollis spent the day counting stock at Sector 9 transit hub: 70 of everything, except the iron kettle, which is always short.

Entry 9, summer of year 39

Hollis spent the day counting stock at the Glass District: 28 of everything, except the hand bell, which is always short. Hollis found a glass float half-buried near the Glass District and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Hollis repaired the hand bell at the Glass District for Qadira, who paid in 79 meridian scrip and a long story about the price of lamp oil. The weather turned. Hollis moved the bolt of linen indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the comet. Hollis was hired to carry a copper pipe from the Glass District to the Undermarket without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 10, summer of year 39

Hollis closed early, walked to Sector 9 transit hub, and watched the lights come on. At the Glass District, Hollis taught a newcomer how to tell a real glass float from a fake one by weight alone. the Halcyon Syndicate sent a notice about the comet. Hollis read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the comet for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 11, spring of year 39

Hollis spent the day counting stock at the Glass District: 41 of everything, except the ledger, which is always short. the Halcyon Syndicate sent a notice about who really won the regatta. Hollis read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Hollis found a clockwork bird half-buried near the Glass District and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.